Unit 6, Oyster Park
109 Chertsey Road
Byfleet, Surrey KT14 7AX

Unit 84, Brindley Road
Astmoor Industrial Estate
Runcorn, Cheshire WA7 1PF

Health and Safety Policy

Created in association with
MB Health and Safety Ltd
Unit 1 Hedley Avenue, Grays Essex RM20 4EL

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Preface

This is the Health and Safety Policy for Geveko Markings (Byfleet and Runcorn), who will be referred to as 'the Company'.

The document contains information which must be followed in order to ensure the continued health, safety and welfare of the Company's employees and contractors whilst continuing to comply with the legislation which governs the work we undertake.

This is a comprehensive document that comprises of the following three sections:

- The Health and Safety Policy Statement.
- The Organisational Duties.
- The Arrangements for Managing Health and Safety.

Health and Safety Policy Statement

This is a general statement of the intentions of the Company with regard to Health and Safety. The policy statement is signed and dated by the most senior member of the Management Team and therefore indicates that Health and Safety is highly regarded, with full commitment to it from the most senior level of the Company.

The Organisational Duties

This section commences with a chart showing the safety structure of the company. It is followed by a list of individual responsibilities of personnel and contractors.

Arrangements for Managing Health and Safety

This section will contain information that will need to be followed by all levels of management, to ensure that the Company complies with current legislation and to reduce the risk to all persons who may be affected by the works carried out on the Company's behalf.

In order to reduce accidents and incidents, all personnel and contractors must adhere to the policies whilst carrying out the company's undertakings.

Where help is needed, the company engages the Health and Safety support services of M^c^Cormack Benson Health and Safety Ltd, for providing competent advice on safety matters, guidance on risk management, safety auditing, safety inspections, advice on training and, should the need occur, to investigate or advise on accidents.

The Company	-	Geveko Markings (Byfleet and Runcorn)
MBHS	-	M^c^Cormack Benson Health and Safety Ltd
HSE	-	Health and Safety Executive
ACoP	-	Approved Code of Practice

Health and Safety Policy Statement

This is the Policy Statement for Geveko Markings (Byfleet and Runcorn), who will be referred to as 'the Company'.

In accordance with its duty under section 2(3) of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974, and in fulfilling its obligations to employees and members of the public who may be affected by its activities, the Company has produced the following statement of policy in respect of Health and Safety:

It is our aim to achieve a working environment that is free of work-related accidents and ill health and to this end we will pursue continuing improvements from year to year.

The Company recognises its Health and Safety duties under the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974 and the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999, and all concomitant legislation, to ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, the health and welfare at work of all employees.

Particular attention will be paid to duties required, namely:

- Provision and maintenance of safe plant and systems of work.
- Safe and healthy use, handling and storage of articles and substances.
- Provision of necessary information, instruction, training and supervision.

We undertake to discharge our statutory duties by:

- Identifying hazards in the workplace, assessing the risks related to them, and implementing appropriate preventative and protective measures.
- Providing and maintaining safe plant and work equipment.
- Establishing and enforcing safe methods of work.
- Recruiting and appointing personnel who have the skills, abilities and competence commensurate with their role and level of responsibility.
- Ensuring that tasks given to employees are consistent with their skills, knowledge and ability to perform.
- Ensuring that technical competence is maintained through the provision of refresher training as appropriate.
- Promoting awareness of Health and Safety and of good practice through the effective communication or relevant information.
- Furnishing sufficient resources needed to meet these objectives.

A successful Health and Safety programme is dependent on the participation and co-operation of all employees. All employees are aware that they have a legal duty to:

- Exercise reasonable care for the Health and Safety of themselves and others who may be affected by their acts or omissions at work.
- Co-operate with and assist the employer in meeting statutory obligations.
- Not intentionally or recklessly interfere with anything provided in the interests of health, safety and welfare.

Our Health and Safety Policy will be reviewed annually as a minimum, to monitor its effectiveness and to ensure that it reflects changing needs and circumstances. The Policy will be subject to additional review to reflect changes to legislative requirements, changes to key personnel in the Company, and advancement in technologies which affect the Company's activities.

Copies of this Health and Safety Policy Statement will be displayed in the workplace. The full company Health and Safety Policy will be available for all employees to read.

All employees, external Consultants and Contractors employed by the Company will be expected to comply with this Health and Safety Policy.

Signed: ..... Managing Director Date: ……..

Review Date: February 2025

Policy Review

It is a requirement of the HASAWA (section 2 (3)) that an Employer shall keep their Health and Safety Policy under regular review to ensure that it remains relevant and reflects the organisation, arrangements and established processes/procedures. The Company will conduct an annual review of this Policy, or more frequently if deemed prudent to do so. This review shall cover all sections of the Policy and shall ensure that:

I. The responsibilities reflect the current management structure of the company.
2. The arrangements for managing Health and Safety remain unchanged.
3. The safe working procedures are still applicable.

Additionally, the Policy shall be reviewed as necessary to reflect any changes in Legislation, significant Company appointments and/or relevant technological advancements.

The Policy review will be completed by the appointed Health and Safety advisors in conjunction with the Company's appointed personnel. Evidence of the Policy review will be summarised in the table below.

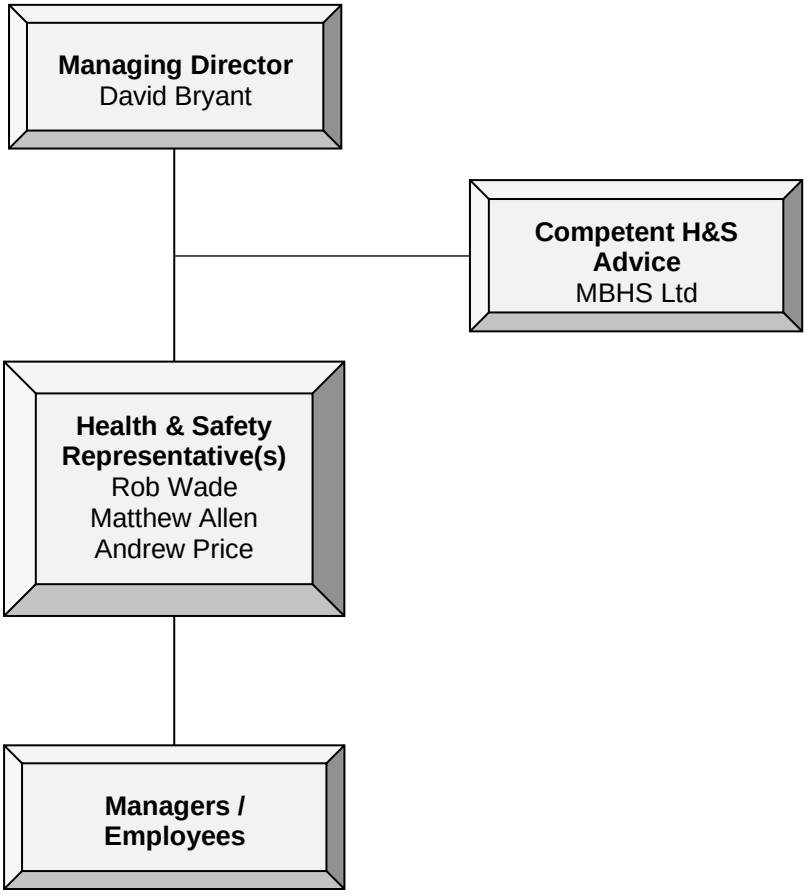
Revision Control & Annual Review Summary

Company Approval		David Bryant (Managing Director)	**MBHS Advisor**	Tony Smith-Allen CMIOSH MIIRSM
Issue Number	**Date**	**Summary Details**		**By Whom**
1.0	March 2022	New Health and Safety Policy		Howard Borstel (MBHS) / Rob Wade, David Bryant (Geveko Markings)
2.0	March 2023	– 'Health & Safety Management Team' now referred to as 'Health & Safety Representative(s)' – Management arrangements for "The Personal Protective Equipment at Work (Amendment) Regulations 2022" included in the Policy (p.16)		Howard Borstel (MBHS) / Rob Wade, David Bryant (Geveko Markings)
3.0	April 2023	– Reference to the new Runcorn site included in the Policy (p.1, 3, 4) – 'Andrew Price' included in Org. Chart (p.6)		Howard Borstel (MBHS) / Rob Wade, David Bryant (Geveko Markings)
4.0	Feb 2024	– MBHS Advisor details updated to reflect change. – Company Org Chart reviewed – no change. – Legislative requirements, no significant change applicable to the Company or it's activities.		Rob Wade, David Bryant (Geveko Markings) Tony Smith-Allen (MBHS)

Organisation – Duties, Roles and Responsibilities

Organisation Chart

The Company have identified and included specific responsibilities in relation to Health and Safety, as they relate to each post in the organisation.



Responsibilities

Managing Director

The Managing Director has ultimate responsibility for ensuring that the Company fulfils its legal responsibilities, that Policy objectives are achieved, and that effective management is in place for the achievement of the policies concerned with health, safety and welfare. The Managing Director will also ensure that Company policies are reviewed as appropriate, in order to secure continuing compliance with existing policies, current legislation and any changes in the law. To these ends, they will ensure the allocation of the resources necessary to maintain sound and efficient Health and Safety arrangements.

Health & Safety Representative(s)

The personnel appointed to these job roles are responsible for implementing this Health and Safety Policy on a day-to-day basis. This includes encouraging and assisting the Company in reviewing and developing safety procedures and ensuring that established rules and safe working practices are adhered to. They must also ensure that employees are properly trained and receive the support they need to perform their duties. A summary of their duties is as follows:

- Ensure that necessary consideration is given at all times to the requirements of this Health and Safety Policy and, in particular, to the following:
    - Safe methods of working.

- Induction training including Health and Safety matters.
- Welfare facilities.
- Fire precautions.
- Hazards arising from work activity.
- Carrying out workplace inspections and advising, as and where necessary, on how to improve methods of working.
- Investigating accidents and dangerous occurrences and recommending means of preventing recurrence.
- Advising and assisting with safety training of personnel.

- They know their own responsibilities for implementing this Health and Safety Policy, as well as those of the employees they are responsible for.
- All accidents, incidents, near misses and dangerous occurrences are fully investigated and preventative actions are recommended.
- Documented safe systems of work are implemented and are adhered to.
- They are aware of, and implement, all safe working practices and procedures.
- Ensuring that all necessary arrangements are made and maintained in respect of emergency plan(s) and procedures.
- Ensuring that all relevant statutory records are regularly maintained and inspected.
- Ensuring that all activities carried out by Company employees will not create a risk or hazard to anyone (either employees or non-employees).
- Ensuring, likewise, that no operation carried out by contractors will place employees, or members of the public, at risk.
- Ensuring that all employees are adequately trained and competent to carry out the work allotted to them without risk.
- Ensuring that, where Health and Safety training needs are identified, arrangements for training will be made as appropriate.
- Ensuring that all Company procedures are adhered to at all times.

Managers

Managers shall provide the necessary support and assistance to the Health & Safety Representative(s) to ensure that the objectives of this health and safety policy are met.

Employees

All employees of the Company will ensure that:

- They are fully conversant with this Health and Safety Policy.
- They co-operate with the Company in meeting its statutory duties.
- They take reasonable care of themselves and others who may be affected by their acts or omissions.
- They do not intentionally or recklessly interfere with or misuse anything provided in the interest of Health and Safety.
- All accidents, incidents, near misses and dangerous occurrences are immediately reported verbally to their direct Supervisor or Line Manager.
- They are fully conversant with all emergency procedures applicable to the area in which they are working.
- All equipment provided for personal safety is used and maintained in a condition fit for that use, and any defects are reported immediately to their direct Supervisor or Line Manager.
- Where an employee identifies any condition which in his or her opinion is hazardous, the situation is immediately reported to their direct Supervisor or Line Manager verbally, by telephone or e-mail.
- During the course of their normal duties, they use equipment and facilities that are fit and proper for the intended purpose in a safe, correct manner, as arranged, provided and/or otherwise approved by the Company.

Health and Safety Advisor

The Company has appointed MBHS as their source of competent advice, to assist in undertaking the measures required to comply with the requirements and prohibitions imposed by or under the relevant statutory provisions.

The Health and Safety Advisor has the responsibility for the following:

- Provision of information and guidance on health and safety matters, where requested by the Company.
- Keeping the Company Health & Safety Representative(s) informed of new and developing legislation and other standards.
- Providing details of individual and company (MBHS) qualifications, membership body affiliations etc., for use with Tenders, Accreditations, or similar.

Company-Appointed Contractor/Consultant

The Company may require, from time-to-time, the services of contractors/Consultants to undertake specialist or non-routine work activities which Company employees are unable to undertake. All contractors/Consultants appointed by the Company must be able to provide auditable evidence of their competency.
A summary of their duties is as follows:

- Will be required to show that they have the necessary expertise and equipment to carry out the particular tasks they have been employed for.
- Will be required to ensure that their work is carried out in a safe manner and that their operatives have been given adequate training.
- Where a Contractor/Consultant is bringing 10 persons or more onto the Company premises, they will be required to nominate a 'Safety Supervisor'. This person is required to liaise with the Company Health & Safety Representative(s) to ensure that all arrangements for safety, health and welfare are dealt with. The appointed Contractor/Consultant ‘Safety Supervisor’ will also be required to carefully monitor and supervise the personnel they are responsible for, ensuring compliance with all relevant regulations and the requirements of the Company Health and Safety Policy.
- Contractors/Consultants are reminded of their responsibilities, not only to their own employees, but also to all other contractors’ employees and others who may be affected by their works, including members of the public.
- They must ensure that the Company is provided with any information available that may affect Health and Safety on site.
- Where any works of a hazardous or dangerous nature are contemplated, they must provide risk assessments and discuss and agree the most suitable method of carrying out the operation with the Company prior to commencing work.
- All plant and equipment provided by the Contractor/Consultant for use by their own personnel, requiring regular inspection or testing, must be maintained and tested as required. Copies of all necessary certificates and registers must be available for review by the Company. Where weekly inspections are required, copies of documentation must be provided to the Company.
- Contractors/Consultants who will use any material or substances likely to jeopardise the Health and Safety of others must provide the Company with specific risk assessments (as required by Control of Substances Hazardous to Health Regulations) that provide all necessary and adequate safety measures.
- Where equipment is to be used which is likely to exceed the levels permitted by the Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005, the Contractor/Consultant should inform the Company in order to ensure that adequate steps are taken to reduce exposure to Company employees.
- Contractors/Consultants are requested to ensure that their employees make proper use of any welfare facilities provided by the Company and that they co-operate fully with the Company Health & Safety Representative(s).
- Contractors/Consultants are requested to ensure that all fire precautions are taken while working on site, that designated fire escape routes are kept clear at all times, that they provide adequate fire equipment suitable to their tasks, and that they co-operate fully with the site fire plan.
- Contractors/Consultants must inspect their working area at the beginning of every shift to ensure that it is safe to proceed with their task. They are responsible for briefing their personnel on all safety issues on site and providing documentary evidence to the Company that this has taken place.

Designated Responsibility Summary

Topic	Responsible Department
Health and Safety Policy review	Managing Director *(supported by MBHS)*
Health and Safety administration	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Facility administration	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Health and Safety training	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Premises risk assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Work activity risk assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Display screen equipment assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Manual handling assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
CoSHH assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Fire risk assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Expectant/New mother risk assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Young Person risk assessments	Health & Safety Representative(s)
First Aid	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Emergency Planning	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Vetting Contractor/Consultants	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Monitoring of Health and Safety in the workplace	Health & Safety Representative(s), Managers, Employees
Site inspections	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Audits	Health & Safety Representative(s)
Accident, Incident and Near Miss investigations	Health & Safety Representative(s)

*** The Company have agreed a level of support from MBHS on the above topics. If assistance is required, please refer to the current contract agreement for clarification of service support level provided.*

Management Arrangements

Visitors and Third Parties

Company premises
Visitors to the company premises may not be aware of the risks associated with the site, therefore all visitors must:

- Proceed, on arrival, to the reception/office area.
- Be made aware of the Company requirements and rules for visitors.
- Be accompanied by the person they are visiting, who in turn is responsible for the visitor's safety and ensuring that visitors are aware of any hazardous process or situation they may be exposed to.

Site locations/work areas/premises
Any visitors to work locations that are under the control of the Company may not be aware of the risks associated with the site, therefore all visitors must:

- Have authorisation from a Company representative to be in the work area.
- Comply with the site rules that are communicated on arrival.
- Adhere to any designated traffic/pedestrian routes.
- Stay within the site area they have been nominated or instructed to visit.

Training and Competency

Preventing accidents and ill health caused by work is a key priority for everyone at the Company. The Managing Director recognises that competent employees are valuable and that providing Health and Safety information and training helps them to:

- Ensure their employees are not injured or made ill by the work they carry out.
- Develop a positive Health and Safety culture, where safe and healthy working becomes second nature to everyone.
- Find out how Health and Safety could be managed better.
- Meet legislative requirements.

Health & Safety Representatives will be provided with all relevant additional training, which will enable them to undertake the Health and Safety responsibilities that have been allocated to them. Health & Safety Representatives will be responsible for ensuring that the Company and all its employees maintain the ethos of continual improvement in Health and Safety standards and culture.

The Management Team will establish a Companywide competency matrix that covers all employees and those working on behalf of the Company. The matrix will outline all levels of training that has been achieved, skills and held competencies including any required refresher or renewal dates of training. This matrix will be reviewed an annual basis, as a minimum, and will provide the Management Team with sufficient information to create a rolling Employee Training and Development plan. It will be the responsibility of the Management Team to ensure that the competency matrix is kept up to date and reflects the standards held by all personnel.

An annual training plan will be established following the review of the competency matrix. The plan will include both internal and external training requirements. Specialist training, both operational and required by legislation, will be included.

Records of all training will be included on the competency matrix and copies of attained certification kept on file.

Mental Health & Well-Being

The Management Team recognise that employees or those working on behalf of the Company do so for a large proportion of their lives and as such can impact on an individuals' well-being. The overlapping and interaction between an individual's home and work life are recognised as potentially creating an increase in general stresses and pressure that they may feel. As such, all are made fully aware that they can approach the Management Team or designated individuals that have received specific training, to discuss any issue or concern that they may have.

To this end the following objectives have been established:

- Build and maintain a workplace environment and culture that supports mental health, overall health, and well-being, and prevents discrimination (including bullying and harassment)
- Increase employee knowledge and awareness of mental health and well-being issues and behaviours
- Where appropriate, develop a programme of initiatives for identified at-risk areas
- Facilitate employees' participation in any initiatives that support well-being and mental health
- Provide training and resources to deliver these initiatives
- Provide support for those affected by well-being issues

Lone Working

The Company endeavours to avoid lone working whenever possible. However, the Management Team are aware that employees may, from time to time, be lone workers at either the Company premises, from their home address or when visiting/working at clients' premises.

Whilst there is no legal requirement to conduct a specific, separate risk assessment for lone workers the Company will ensure that issues and hazards that may significantly affect or impact those lone working are included within the relevant activity or task-based risk assessments. These assessments will also include the relevant mitigation control measures required to eliminate, avoid or at lease minimise the outcome of any hazard to as low as reasonably practicable.

Those employees that are selected or identified as being a lone worker will be sufficiently experienced and fully understand the risks and precautions involved in their work and the location that they work in. The Management Team will outline and set the limits to what can and cannot be done while working alone and will ensure employees that are lone working are:

- competent to deal with the requirements of the job;
- suitably trained in the use of any technical solutions provided;
- able to recognise when to seek advice from elsewhere.

All those employees that are lone working must:

- Ensure they have read and understood any risk assessments that have been compiled for the activity they are working on, especially any detailed arrangements where lone working is applicable.
- Ensure they adhere to any systems developed for their protection while working alone.
- Take personal responsibility for sharing information regarding their whereabouts (time out, location being visited, contact details, expected time of return).
- Report any incidents concerning lone working to enable systems to be reviewed and revised.
- If not returning to the Company base at the end of the last visit, notify their appointed member of the Company Management Team to inform them that they have left their client/location and they are okay (or otherwise).

Refusal to Work on the Grounds of Health and Safety

Employees, self-employed and contractors/consultants of the Company will at all times exercise diligence in monitoring their safe working environment for themselves and other persons in the working area.

It is a condition that all employees, self-employed and contractors/consultants shall comply with the following:
If any situation arises which an employee believes will or has resulted in an unsafe working environment for some or all, they must bring their concern to the attention of their direct supervisor so it can be investigated and resolved to an acceptable conclusion, if possible.

- The employee must clearly describe what the concerns or issues actually are.
- If a member of the Company Management Team cannot be immediately contacted the relevant work should <u>stop</u>.
- The most senior member of staff will check that there are no instructions or information available to resolve the issue.
- If the member of the Company Management Team does not support the concern, a 'second opinion' is to be sought to either verify the findings or support the concerns.

- Providing the concern is genuine, even if it is ultimately seen to be unfounded, the employee will not be the subject of any detrimental action by the company.

The Company will take all reasonable measures to ensure that those persons covered by this process (employees, self-employed, contractors/consultants) are aware that their continued employment will not be affected in the event of any invoking of this policy.

Accident, Incident and Near Miss Reporting

Accidents (no matter how minor an injury may be), incidents, and near misses will be included in the accident book located at the company premises.

If an accident, incident, or near miss has occurred in a work situation then a member of the Management Team will review the events to establish the actual or underlying cause. This process should enable the Company to establish which existing processes require amending and/or identify additional control measures that will be required to prevent a re-occurrence. The fact that there is an accident at work premises does not, in itself, mean that the accident is work-related – the work activity itself must contribute to the accident. An accident is 'work-related' if any of the following played a significant role:

- the way the work was carried out
- any machinery, plant, substances, or equipment used for the work
- the condition of the site or premises where the accident happened

The Company recognises and accepts the legal duties placed upon them by the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 2013 that require them to report and record some work-related accidents.

The timescales for reporting and/or recording accident information is:

- Accidents resulting in the death of any person, specified injuries to workers, non-fatal accidents requiring hospital treatment to non-workers and dangerous occurrences must be reported without delay (fatal accidents or accidents resulting in a specified injury to a worker can be reported by telephone 0845 300 9923). **A report must be submitted to the HSE within 10 days of the incident.**
- Over-seven-day injuries, where an employee or self-employed person is away from work or unable to perform their normal work duties for more than 7 consecutive days. **A report must be submitted to the HSE within 15 days of the incident.**
- Over-three day-injuries will be recorded using the Company accident book/form and filed securely to protect any personal information.

Incapacitation means that the worker is absent or is unable to do work that they would reasonably be expected to do as part of their normal work.

The Company also accept that they must report, without delay, confirmed diagnoses of certain occupational diseases, where these are likely to have been caused or made worse by their work. These diseases include:

- carpal tunnel syndrome
- severe cramp of the hand or forearm
- occupational dermatitis
- hand-arm vibration syndrome
- occupational asthma
- tendonitis or tenosynovitis of the hand or forearm
- any occupational cancer
- any disease attributed to an occupational exposure to a biological agent

Clarification on the criteria relating to the above will be sought via the HSE website and MBHS.

All reporting of any accident/incident, occupational disease etc will be reported online via the Health and Safety Executive website.

Accident/Incident records, including accident book entries and RIDDOR notifications will be retained for 3 years from the date of the last entry (or, if the accident involves a child/ young adult, then until that person reaches the age of 21). Retention of other medical records related to particular topics or events are detailed within the relevant section of this policy.

The Company Management Team will contact MBHS for further advice and guidance if required.

The Workplace (Health, Safety & Welfare) Regulations 1992

The Management Team ensures that the company premises meet the health, safety and welfare needs of all its employees, contractors, members of the public and people with disabilities. Due consideration has been given to the working environment, ensuring it is adequate in respect of ventilation, working temperature, lighting, cleaning materials, traffic routes, falling objects, translucent doors, general welfare, toilets, washing facilities, drinking water and eating facilities.

Welfare facilities are provided by the client when employees are required to work away from the Company premises. When these facilities are not provided or made available for use by an employee, employees will utilise local public facilities or the facilities of local businesses, with agreement with the provider of the facilities.

Home Based Working

The Company recognises and accepts that their health and safety responsibilities are the same for those employees that are appointed or required to work from home, as they are for any other member of the workforce.

Before a member of the workforce is authorised to work from home, either on a temporary or permanent basis, the Company will give due consideration to the following areas:

- The nature and duration of the work to be undertaken?
- Whether the work activities can be safely carried out from home?
- Is specialised equipment, including remote access to IT systems, and/or skill set required to carry out the tasks required?
- The control measures that will need to be implemented to protect them?
- How communication will be maintained between the Company and the homeworker?

The Company will undertake a 'suitable and sufficient' assessment relating to home working in collaboration with the proposed homeworker covering the aforementioned topics in sufficient detail, to enable the Management Team to make a decision on whether home working can be carried out in a manner that ensures the health, safety and wellbeing of the individual concerned.

The Manual Handling Operations Regulations 1992

The Company is aware of the requirements placed upon it by the regulations. In order to meet these legislative requirements and to protect those employees who may be affected by manual handling activity, the Company will:

- So far as is reasonably practicable avoid the need for hazardous manual handling.
- Conduct a suitable risk assessment for any hazardous manual handling that cannot be avoided.
- So far as is reasonably practicable reduce the risk of injury from hazardous manual handling.

Manual handling risk assessments will be conducted by the Management Team and will take into account:

- The task being completed and how the risk(s) can be reduced.
- The individual(s) conducting the task and any training requirement.
- The load involved in the activity and any method that could be used to reduce it to a more manageable size.
- The work environment where the activity will take place.

Employees of the Company are made aware of their responsibilities and duties during the induction process and via a manual handling guidance document. All employees will:

- Follow any implemented safe systems of work.
- Use any supplied equipment in the manner they have been trained to do.
- Co-operate with the Company on Health and Safety matters.
- Tell their line manager/supervisor if they identify hazardous handling activities.
- Make sure that their work activities do not put others at risk.

The Health and Safety (Display Screen Equipment) Regulations 1992

The Management Team will consider tasks undertaken by employees and any individual that is identified as being a DSE "user" of display screen equipment, e.g. PC/laptop users, are required to complete a workstation self-assessment form. The HSE definition of a "user" - a person who uses DSE on a daily basis for an hour or more at a time - will be applied by the Management Team. Completed forms are reviewed by the Health & Safety Representative(s) and any issues or queries will be discussed with the DSE user. The assessments will consider factors such as the workstation set-up, equipment (chair, keyboard, screen, etc.), the environment (lighting, heating, etc.), and types of work being completed.

The Company will ensure that free eye/eyesight testing and correction is available for those employees identified as using DSE.

The Health & Safety Representative(s) ensure that all relevant training and information is provided to an employee to enable them to undertake the work involving DSE in a safe manner.

The Health and Safety (Consultation with Employees) Regulations 1996

The Company recognise that having, and maintaining, a mechanism for communicating relevant Health and Safety information is important in establishing an on-going positive Health and Safety culture. To this end, the Company will consult with employees or their representatives on the following:

- The introduction of any work activity or issue which may substantially affect their Health and Safety at work, for example the introduction of new equipment or new systems of work.
- The contact details of the person nominated as the company competent person with regards to Health and Safety.
- Information on the risks and dangers arising from the work activities, measures implemented to reduce or get rid of these risks, and what employees should do if they are exposed to a risk.
- The planning/organisation for Health and Safety training.

Additional information is displayed via the HSE poster displayed in the workplace, safety posters, leaflets, safety pamphlets and verbal safety information.

The Company encourages all employees to enter into the spirit of the regulations by taking part in discussions with their supervisor/line manager. Any required actions from the discussions are agreed with both parties and escalated through the Health & Safety Representative(s) for opinion and rectification where necessary. Any action taken as a result of the information given by an employee will be communicated directly to them.

The Company fully involves, or will involve, non-English speaking employees, including labour only. The Health & Safety Representative(s) will utilise documents that are readily available on the HSE website in different languages. These documents and any specific site instructions will be aided by pictograms and interpreters if required.

The Electricity at Work Regulations 1989

The Company will ensure electrical equipment is physically capable of doing the job and designed and constructed so that mechanical and electrical stresses do not cause the equipment to become unsafe. Electrical equipment will be visually checked by the user to spot early signs of damage or deterioration. The user's visual check will include:

- Switching off and unplugging the equipment before any checks.
- Checking that the plug is correctly wired (but only if they are competent to do so).
- Ensuring that the fuse is correctly rated by checking the equipment rating plate or instruction book.
- Checking that the plug is not damaged and that the cable is properly secured, with no internal wires visible.
- Checking the electrical cable is not damaged and has not been repaired with insulating tape or an unsuitable connector (damaged cable will only be replaced with a new cable by a competent person).
- Checking that the outer cover of the equipment is not damaged in a way that will give rise to electrical or mechanical hazards.
- Checking for burn marks or staining that suggests the equipment is overheating.
- Ensuring any trailing wires are positioned so that they are not a trip hazard and are less likely to get damaged.

If employees are concerned about the safety of equipment, they are advised to stop it from being used and report the matter to the Health & Safety Representative(s), who will arrange for the faulty equipment to be removed from service until a qualified electrician undertakes a more thorough check.

The Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations 1992

The Company recognises that Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) should only be used when risks cannot be avoided or sufficiently reduced by other preventative measures or through work re-organisation. The company will ensure that there is sufficient supply of PPE when required and that all employees are suitably trained in its safe storage and use.

PPE will be provided free of charge to all employees. Allocation of PPE will be supervised by the Health & Safety Representative(s) who will monitor it's use and, in consultation with those wearing it, ensure that it remains suitable, wearable and provides the correct level of for the task in hand.

Other persons working on behalf of the Company e.g. self-employed, labour agency will be obliged to meet/provide specific PPE requirements. Where this is not possible, the Company may decide to provide any required PPE, but the cost of this provision will not be at the Company expense. In these instances, agreement on payment for PPE will be with the persons "employer" and not the person (unless they are one and the same e.g. self-employed person).

It is the employee's and sub-contractor's duty to not misuse or interfere with any Health and Safety equipment, including PPE, supplied for their safety. All PPE issued must be worn, used, and stored as per the manufacturer's specification.

The Health & Safety Representative(s) shall ensure that a suitable review is completed when more than one type of PPE is being worn, to confirm that each type of equipment is compatible with the other(s) and continues to provide suitable protection for the wearer.

The Personal Protective Equipment at Work (Amendment) Regulations 2022

The Company recognise the amendments that have been made relating to the types of duties and responsibilities that both they and their employees under PPER 1992 remain unchanged but have now been extended to limb (b) workers, as defined in PPER 2022. The Regulations provide clarification on those that would be classified as a worker under "limb (b)" and generally they are those that:

- carry out casual or irregular work for one or more organisations
- after 1 month of continuous service, receive holiday pay but not other employment rights such as the minimum period of statutory notice
- only carry out work if they choose to
- have a contract or other arrangement to do work or services personally for a reward (the contract doesn't have to be written) and only have a limited right to send someone else to do the work, for example swapping shifts with someone on a pre-approved list (subcontracting)
- are not in business for themselves (they do not advertise services directly to customers who can then also book their services directly)

Limb (b) category of "worker" is generally not used by the Company.

These changes do not apply to those who have a 'self-employed' status.

The Control of Substances Hazardous to Health Regulations 2002

Before any hazardous substances are used during a work process, a safety data sheet (SDS) will be requested from the supplier and an appropriate assessment made of the risks from that substance undertaken by the Health & Safety Representative(s).

Alternative less harmful substances will be used wherever possible.

Assessments will consider storage, handling, and aspects of use, exposure, PPE requirements, workers' health, and emergency actions. The Health & Safety Representative(s) will brief employees on any hazard or substance precautions, with written records being held at the Company premises. Employee Health Surveillance records, as specified by and within this legislation, will be retained for 40 years from the date of the last entry.

Following the assessment, any substance or material that has a flammable content will be stored in a separate area and held within a metal, fire retardant cabinet.

In order to comply with the legislative requirements placed upon it, the Company will provide adequate control of exposure to substances by:

- Applying the eight principles of good practice
    - *Design and operate processes and activities to minimise emission, release, and spread of substances hazardous to health.*
    - *Take into account all relevant routes of exposure - inhalation, skin absorption, and ingestion - when developing control measures.*
    - *Control exposure by utilising measures proportionate to the health risk.*
    - *Choose the most effective and reliable control options which minimise the escape and spread of substances hazardous to health.*
    - *Where adequate control of exposure cannot be achieved by other means, provide, in conjunction with other control measures, suitable Personal Protective Equipment.*

- *Check and review regularly all elements of control measures for their continuing effectiveness.*
- *Inform and train all employees on the hazards and risks from the substances with which they work and the use of control measures developed to minimise the risks.*
- *Ensure that the introduction of control measures does not increase the overall risk to Health and Safety.*

- Ensuring that the Workplace Exposure Limit is not exceeded.
- Ensuring that exposure to substances which can cause occupational asthma, cancer, or damage to genes that can be passed from one generation to another, is reduced as low as is reasonably practicable.
- Ensuring that records of tests and examinations of control systems and protective equipment identified as control measures under the legislation are retained for at least 5 years.

The Work at Height Regulations 2005 (amended 2007)

It is the policy of the Company to comply with the Work at Height Regulations 2005, which apply to all work at height where there is a risk of a fall liable to cause personal injury. A place is 'at height' if a person could be injured falling from it, even if it is at or below ground level. 'Work' includes moving around at a place of work (except by a staircase in a permanent workplace) but not travel to or from a place of work.

In accordance with these regulations, the Company will:

- Avoid work at height wherever possible.
- Use work equipment or other measures to prevent falls where they cannot avoid working at height.
- Where a risk of a fall cannot be eliminated, use work equipment or other measures to minimise the distance and consequences of a fall, should one occur.

Before any work at height takes place, the below must be followed:

- If there is an alternative means of carrying out work, which removes the need to work at height, this should be utilised.
- All work at height must be properly planned and organised.
- All work at height must be carried out under appropriate supervision, in as safe a way as is reasonably practicable.

For all work at height, the Company will:

- Use the most suitable equipment.
- Give collective protection measures (e.g. guard rails) priority over personal protection measures (e.g. safety harness).
- Take account of the work conditions and the risks to the safety of all those at the place where the work equipment is to be used.
- Plan for emergencies and rescue.
- Take into account weather conditions that could endanger Health and Safety.
- Ensure that those working at height are trained and competent.
- Ensure that the place where work at height is done is safe.
- Ensure that the equipment is appropriately inspected.
- Ensure that the risks from fragile surfaces and falling objects are properly controlled.
- Take account of the relevant risk assessments that have been carried out.

The Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005

The Company will make a suitable and sufficient assessment of the risks to which relevant persons are exposed whilst working at the premises. This assessment will be used for the purpose of identifying the measures they need to take to comply with the requirements and prohibitions imposed on them by the Order. The nature of the assessment will vary according to the type and use of the premises, the persons who use or may use the premises, and the risks associated with that use. The completed risk assessment will be reviewed regularly by the Health & Safety Representative(s) to ensure it remains up to date and valid, and to reflect any significant changes that may have taken place.

The Company will ensure systems are in place to check all fire procedures and that monitoring, testing and maintenance of fire fighting equipment, emergency lighting and alarm systems, is completed. Health & Safety Representative(s) will conduct regular tours/inspections of the premises and work activities to ensure that identified control measures have been implemented.

Fire Action signage will be placed in prominent positions throughout the premises to act as a reminder for all employees, visitors, contractors, etc. of the emergency evacuation procedure.

The fire procedures will be under the control of the Health & Safety Representative(s).

The Provision and Use of Work Equipment Regulations 1998

As a means of ensuring that tools and equipment provided for work activities are suitable, the Health & Safety Representative(s) will conduct a suitable assessment to consider the current provision of protection and preventative measures.

All tools and equipment purchased, and used by employees, will have suitable control measures to protect employees against risks associated with dangerous parts of machinery, e.g. fixed guards, interlocked guards, etc. Equipment will be checked by the user prior to use, ensuring that all controls, indicators, switches, and displays are clear and free from obstruction, dirt, damage, etc. If any faults, defects, or concerns are identified during the pre-use checks it is the responsibility of the user to notify their Supervisor/Manager and await a decision on rectification/replacement. All faulty/defective tools will be removed from service to prevent them being used.

All users of Company tools and equipment will be suitably trained in their use. The Health & Safety Representative(s) ensures that all relevant information and instructions on the use of work equipment is readily available to all employees for review.

All equipment will be maintained in good working order by the Company. Employees are required to liaise with their Health & Safety Representative(s) if they have any queries or concerns regarding a piece of equipment. The piece of equipment in question will be removed from service to prevent use and a suitable replacement acquired.

The Company is aware that for larger pieces of equipment, for example a fixed piece of machinery, an immediate replacement is not practical. In this circumstance, the Management Team will arrange for a suitable repair to be completed by a person with the relevant competency and skill set.

On occasions, the Company may need to hire in equipment, due to specialised work or quantity of work. The equipment will only be obtained from approved hire companies which supply the appropriate training and supporting documentation to ensure all employees and sub-contractors are suitably trained in the use of the equipment.

The Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999

The Company will make appropriate arrangements for effective preventative or protective measures identified as a result of risk assessments. The Health & Safety Representative(s), will ensure that:

- All premises and activities subject to risk assessments are assessed in accordance with the relevant legislation, using an appropriate documented format.
- Such assessments are repeated whenever any of the following factors occur:
  - Change in legislation.
  - Change in control measures.
  - Significant change in work carried out.
  - Transfer to new technology.
  - Original assessment is no longer valid.
- Assessments are recorded and copies held at the company premises.
- The results of all such assessments are communicated to, and available for inspection by, all employees (an acknowledgement form will be used to ensure that all persons affected by the work activity or premises have read and understood the content and the role they must undertake).
- All assessments identify necessary protective and preventative measures.
- Specific assessments are completed for specified groups – Young Persons, Expectant/New Mothers.

The Management Team will monitor safety performance on an informal daily basis by visual inspections, observations and ensuring discussions relating to health and safety topics/issues with employees.

The Company have appointed MBHS as their source for Health and Safety assistance and competent advice and will have ready access to a suitably competent advisor.

The Health and Safety (First Aid) Regulations 1981

The Company ensures that a sufficient number of employees are identified and trained in emergency aid and/or are First Aiders. The identity and location of the nominated First Aid employees will be included on notice boards and

the specific First Aid signage. First Aid kits will be located throughout the premises, and it is the responsibility of the First Aid personnel to ensure that the kits are checked on a regular basis and remain suitably stocked.

Each Company vehicle is equipped with a First Aid kit which is easily accessible to all employees at any one time during working hours. The kits are checked and restocked by the Company every three months, unless the employee notifies the Health & Safety Representative(s) that supplies have been used up, in which case items will be restocked as and when required.

Protection of Young Persons

The Company will ensure that young persons (under 18 years of age) employed by them are protected at work from any risks to their Health and Safety which are a consequence of their lack of experience or because they have not yet fully mentally and physically matured. Therefore, a specific risk assessment will be undertaken before work commences, as part of the induction process for young persons.

Where this concerns a child (not over compulsory school age), in addition to carrying out this assessment, its findings must be communicated to a person having parental responsibilities/rights for that child. Where the young person is on a 'relevant' scheme, i.e. work placement, then the placement organisation must be involved in the assessment process.

Persons under 18 years of age are prohibited from use of the following equipment, unless attending approved training/instruction under the direction of a qualified and competent person:

- The Press.
- Mobile plant, i.e. Fork-lift truck.
- Access equipment, i.e. ladders.

New and Expectant Mothers

The Company is aware of the obligations placed upon them by legislation regarding an employee who has notified them in writing that she is a new or expectant mother. When an employee provides written notification (regulation 18 of MHSW) to the Company stating that she is pregnant, or that she has given birth within the past six months, or that she is breastfeeding, the Health & Safety Representative(s) will immediately review any risk assessments applicable to the work activity(s) being undertaken. In addition to this review, the Health & Safety Representative(s) will conduct a specific assessment for the employee in question. If this risk assessment has identified any risks to the Health and Safety of a new or expectant mother, or that of her baby, and these risks cannot be avoided by taking any necessary preventative and protective measures under other relevant Health and Safety legislation, then the Company will take action to remove, reduce or control the risk. If the risk cannot be removed, the Company will take the following actions:

Action 1 - Temporarily adjusts the employee's working conditions and/or hours of work or, if that is not possible:
Action 2 - Offer her suitable alternative work (at the same rate of pay) if available or if that is not feasible:
Action 3 - Suspend her from work on paid leave for as long as necessary, to protect her Health and Safety, and that of her child.

Violence and Aggression

The Company, both as an organisation and a Management Team, will not tolerate harassment and violence of any kind. This stance is followed throughout the Company and includes the relationships between colleagues, employees, and client staff, and between staff and any other third party.

Issues of harassment and violence will be treated as disciplinary offences (up to and including dismissal or, if appropriate, criminal action). The list below is an indicator as to what constitutes harassment or violent conduct. It is not an exhaustive list and other issues may be considered by the management team as equal to those listed below:

- Physical violence.
- Verbal violence and aggression (abusive language, swearing).
- Sexual innuendo.
- Intimidation.
- Invasion of personal privacy.
- Exclusion of individuals.
- Abusive or prank phone calls/emails.

False accusations of harassment or violence will not be tolerated by the Company and may result in the accuser facing disciplinary action.

The Company will provide support, via the Management Team, to anyone who has been subjected to harassment/violence. This support may include counselling by a health professional.

The Company will ensure that training is provided to employees to prevent and deal with the risks of harassment and violence. The Company will conduct risk assessments for their work activities and include/consider risks to employees from violence and aggression.

The Lifting Operations and Lifting Equipment Regulations 1998

The Company will ensure that lifting equipment will be subjected to an assessment to ensure the equipment is suitable for the intended task. This assessment will ensure that lifting equipment provided for use at work is:

- Strong and stable enough for the particular use and marked to indicate safe working loads.
- Positioned and installed to minimise any risks.
- Used safely. i.e. the work is planned, organised and performed by competent people.
- Subject to on-going thorough examination and, where appropriate, inspection by competent people.

Thorough Examinations completed by an independent “competent person” are arranged by the management team at a frequency that is in line with the requirements specified within the Regulations:

- in the case of lifting equipment for lifting persons or an accessory for lifting, at least every 6 months.
- in the case of other lifting equipment, at least every 12 months.
- in either case, in accordance with an examination scheme.
- each time that exceptional circumstances which are liable to jeopardise the safety of the lifting equipment have occurred.

The Dangerous Substances and Explosive Atmospheres Regulations 2002

The Company will ensure that where a dangerous substance is, or **is liable** to be, present, a suitable and sufficient assessment of the risks will be completed by a competent person. The regulation imposes a duty to classify workplaces into hazardous and non-hazardous areas. These areas will be defined and signage indicating their location will be posted around the site.

Where elimination of a substance cannot be achieved, the Company will:

- Reduce the number of dangerous substances to a minimum.
- Avoid any minimal release.
- Control the release at source, i.e. by extraction systems.
- Prevent the formation of an explosive atmosphere.
- Following any release, the collection, containment, and removal will be done in a controlled and safe manner.
- Avoid ignition sources.
- Segregate incompatible substances.
- Ensure that containers of dangerous substances will be appropriately labelled that clearly identify the contents and any associated hazards.

Provide employees with suitable and sufficient information, instruction and training on the appropriate precautions and actions to be taken in order to safeguard themselves and other employees at the workplace, where a dangerous substance is present.

The Company will put in place procedures and arrangements necessary to deal with an accident, incident, or emergency relating to a dangerous substance in the workplace.

Workplace Transport Safety

All work vehicles provided and used by the Company will be suitable for the purpose for which they are provided.

The Company will ensure that vehicles are provided with a safe way to get into and out of the cab, and any other parts of the vehicle that need to be accessed regularly. All company vehicles will provide protection for drivers against any event that can harm them (e.g. bad weather, falling objects, inhospitable environment, vehicle overturns, etc.).

Drivers of company vehicles are required to conduct a pre-use visual inspection. This check includes ensuring all lights and indicators are working and that they have clear and unobstructed visibility around the vehicle.

All work vehicles provided by the Company will be suitable for their intended purpose and capable of carrying any specified load intended. The Safe Working Load (SWL) MUST NEVER exceeded by company drivers.

Workplace vehicles will be subject to a routine maintenance program by a competent and qualified person. This includes any legislative requirements placed upon types of equipment, e.g. Fork lift truck.

All those employees required to use work vehicles will either have an existing qualification that they have achieved through training, or the Company will provide adequate resources to train the employee (using a suitably qualified, competent trained person) in the safe use and operation of the vehicle. Training will be reviewed, monitored, and provided on an on-going basis to ensure suitable CPD (Continuous Professional Development) is maintained.

The Company will authorise nominated employees to drive company work vehicles. This authorisation will only be given on the proviso that the employee is suitably trained, qualified (where appropriate) and competent to drive the vehicle.